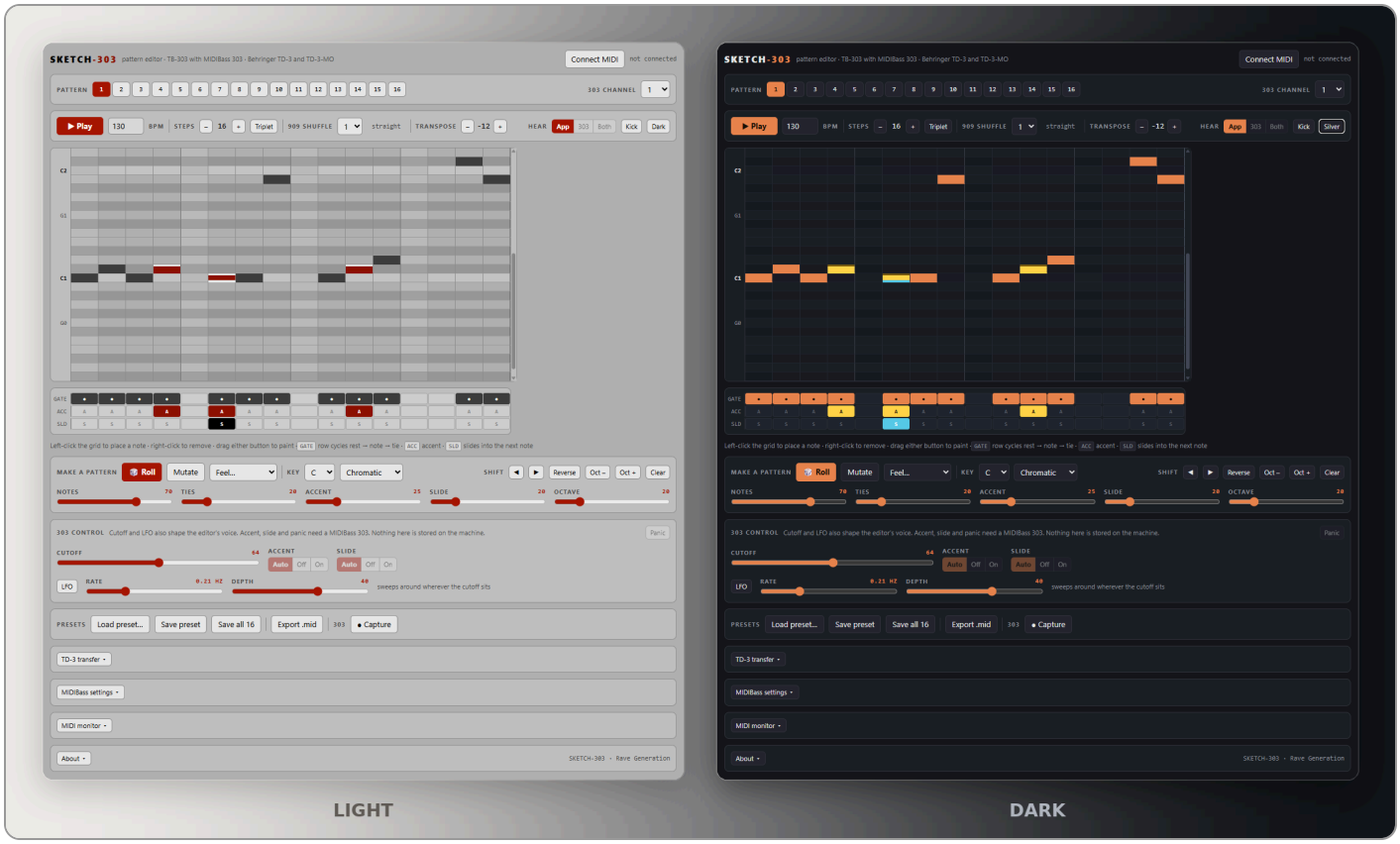
SKETCH-303

Pattern editor for the Roland TB-303 and the Behringer TD-3. Manual.

A piano roll instead of sixteen step buttons, a generator for when the blank grid stares back, TR-909 shuffle measured from hardware, and an acid voice built in so it works with nothing plugged in. Over MIDI it plays either machine, records a 303's own sequencer back into the grid, and moves patterns in and out of a TD-3's memory slots.



Silver and dark. The button at the top right switches.

RUNNING IT

In a browser	Open the page. Chrome or Edge if you want the MIDI features.
Installed	Chrome and Edge show an Install icon in the address bar. It gets its own window and keeps working offline.
Windows	Run the installer, 64-bit.
macOS	Open the .dmg and drag the app to Applications. Universal, so Apple Silicon and Intel both.

It is the same app in all four cases. Patterns are stored per install, so a bank saved in the browser is not visible to the desktop app. Use **Save all 16** in one and **Load preset** in the other to move them across.

MAKING A PATTERN

Left-click the grid to place a note, right-click to remove one, drag with either button to paint a run. Four octaves are in view, and the grid scrolls.

Three lanes sit under the roll:

GATE Cycles rest, note, tie. Step one can never be a tie.

ACC Accent. Goes out as note velocity.

SLD Slide into the next note. Goes out as an overlapping note, and the machine makes the slide itself.

The generator

Roll builds a pattern from the five sliders: notes, ties, accent, slide, octave. Pitches follow a bounded random walk over the chosen key and scale, so a roll comes out as a line with shape rather than a shuffle of unrelated notes. **Mutate** rerolls about a quarter of the steps when a pattern is nearly right. **Feel** sets the sliders and rolls in one click.

Shift, **Reverse**, **Oct** and **Clear** work on whatever is on screen.

PLAYING IT

Play Starts and stops. `Space` does the same.

Steps Pattern length, 1 to 32, or 1 to 24 in triplet.

Triplet Three steps to the beat instead of four, so steps get longer and 12 steps is a bar.

909 Shuffle Matches the TR-909 Main Keys 1 to 7. 1 is straight, key 5 is 2:1, key 7 is 3:1. Every second step is pushed late, the rest stay on the grid, so the bar never drifts.

Hear App plays the built-in voice, 303 sends MIDI out instead, Both does each at once.

Kick Metronome on the beat. You hear it locally, it is never transmitted.

Cutoff shapes the built-in voice and goes out as CC1 and CC74 together, so a MIDIBass 303 and a TD-3-MO both follow it. The LFO sweeps around wherever the cutoff sits.

WITH A TB-303

Press **Connect MIDI** and pick your interface. A TB-303 needs a Sequentix MIDIBass 303 retrofit fitted for any of this to work.

MIDIBass settings holds all twelve EEPROM parameters, written straight to the unit and kept through a power cycle. The unit cannot report its settings back, so the panel shows what you last sent rather than what is actually in it.

Capture

A TB-303 has no pattern memory a computer can reach, so the editor records what the machine transmits instead. Set Steps to the pattern length, turn Sync out on, press **Capture**, then start the machine. It counts the 303's own clock at six ticks per step and stops itself. Pitch, accent, slide and tie all survive the trip.

WITH A TD-3

A TD-3 or TD-3-MO needs nothing fitted. Open **TD-3 transfer**, choose group, section and pattern, then:

Read slot Pulls that pattern into the editor. Reading never changes anything on the machine.

Flash to TD-3 Overwrites that slot with what is on screen.

Save slot backup Writes the slot as it stands to a .syx file.

> **Read before you flash.** Writing is read-modify-write: only the documented fields are replaced, and the bytes the format still lists as unknown are carried through untouched. The app requires a read of the same slot first, which is also how you take a backup.

A standard TD-3 has no MIDI route to its filter and ignores the cutoff CCs. A TD-3-MO follows CC74.

SAVING AND EXPORTING

Pattern 1 to 16	Sixteen slots kept in the browser. Slots holding notes are marked.
Save preset	Saves the pattern on screen as .json.
Save all 16	Saves every slot in one file. This is the one to back up with.
Export .mid	A standard MIDI file with the shuffle already in the timing and slides as overlapping notes, so a DAW plays back what you heard.

IF SOMETHING IS WRONG

No MIDI devices show up

Use Chrome or Edge. Safari has no Web MIDI at all, and Firefox needs it enabled. Close anything else holding the port, DAWs included, then press Connect MIDI again. The desktop app grants itself MIDI access, so it does not ask.

Windows says the installer is unrecognised

The build is unsigned, so SmartScreen shows "Windows protected your PC". Click More info, then Run anyway.

macOS refuses to open the app

If the copy you have is not notarised, right-click the app and choose Open, then confirm. The plain double-click is what Gatekeeper blocks.

Notes play but the 303 does not slide

Slide is an overlapping note, so the unit needs to receive both notes on the same channel with Local set the way the MIDIBass expects. Check the SLD lane is actually set, and watch it arrive in the MIDI monitor.

Everything sounds accented

Accent is velocity. Plain notes leave at 80 and accented at 127. If your unit is set to an accent threshold below 80, lower the threshold or raise it above 80 in MIDIBass settings.

Watching the wire

MIDI monitor shows every byte in and out with a decode: notes by name and velocity, CCs by function, SysEx read against the settings table. Clock is filtered out by default or it buries everything else. On a machine that answers nothing, this is the only diagnostic there is.